

Question:

A 60-year-old woman is brought to the emergency department because of altered mental status for 2 hours. She and her husband were at the grocery store when she suddenly could not remember why she was there or how she got there. She has not had any head trauma. She has a history of depression and migraines. She does not smoke and drinks a glass of wine each night with dinner. She takes fluoxetine daily. She appears distressed and anxious. Her vital signs are within normal limits. She is fully alert and oriented to self and place but not to time. Every few minutes she asks how she got to the emergency department. She is able to follow commands and sustain attention. She recalls 3/3 objects immediately and recalls 0/3 objects at 5 minutes. The remainder of the neurological exam shows no abnormalities. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Transient global amnesia
- B. Depersonalization/derealization disorder
- C. Seizure
- D. Migraine

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's symptoms of sudden onset of memory loss , confusion , and dis orientation to time , along with the inability to recall recent events , suggest a transient cognitive disturbance . The patient's history of depression and migraines is also noted . However , the absence of head trauma , normal vital signs , and normal neurological exam , except for the cognitive impairment , make a structural cause less likely . The patient's ability to recall objects immediately and forget them shortly after , suggests a disturbance in short-term memory . The patient's symptoms are most consistent with a transient global amnesia , which is characterized by sudden , transient memory loss for personal identity or important information , usually lasting hours , without a clear cause . The patient's history of depression and the absence of other symptoms such as depersonalization or a seizure , make these options less likely . </think>< answer> A . Transient global amnesia </answer>

